

them: to run an Instagram account, write up marketing emails, or do other tasks that can be done on a computer from anywhere. These gigs can also provide flexible hours, which you'll need as a high school student with homework and exams on your plate.

- 5. PUT YOUR BEST FOOT FORWARD.** Start by creating a résumé that you feel good about. There might not be a lot to put on it at first, but you can list teachers or coaches or religious leaders as references. When detailing your experience, you can put responsibilities you've had at school or your extracurricular activities—anything to show leadership and work ethic. All of it is relevant. Your résumé shouldn't be long, anyway—one page or less.

When you fill out a job application (which you can request from the manager/supervisor or find online), you should show it to someone else prior to handing it in—even a friend. Another pair of eyes might point out missing words or misspellings or some skill that you forgot to mention. Run everything you're doing by a trusted adult so that person can see if the job is safe and/or if you're presenting yourself well on paper and in interviews. (You can also google résumé help websites like ResumeRobin.com and others for tips.) Hand in the application and résumé to the *manager*, not another employee. And don't send a parent to hand in your application for you.

- 6. KEEP TRYING.** Throw spaghetti at the wall and see what sticks. Apply to locations that you might think are too far away (don't just pick the Gap by your house when there are multiple locations). Be open-minded. When I was a teen, I thought it would make me cool to work at Bath and Body Works, but I wasn't getting hired there. Where you do end up doesn't say anything about your self-worth. None of my jobs allowed me to smell like Cucumber Melon mist spray, but they were all jobs just the same.